

Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference

1. Purpose and customer promise

Variation families exist to help shoppers compare the same product across a narrow, predictable attribute such as color, size, or count.

A parent must not combine products that differ in core function, material system, safety profile, included accessory set, or shopper expectation.

2. Allowed variation themes

['Theme', 'Allowed when', 'Not allowed when']	['Color', 'Same product, material, capacity, function', 'Color also changes material or included components']	['Size', 'Same product line and function; size clearly encoded', 'Size changes material grade or bundle offer']	['Pack count', 'Only when the marketplace category permits pack-count theme', 'Cannot hide bundle/price promotion under a color or size theme']
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3. Category exception notes

['Exception', 'Applies only when', 'Reviewer caution']	['Size + Color rebuild', 'All children share material, function, cap family, and pack count', 'A rebuild requires a new parent strategy and existing child migration plan']	['Accessory cap family', 'The category template exposes cap-style as an approved variation dimension', 'Do not treat added infuser, straw, or bamboo lid as mere color unless all children share that cap family']	['Duplicate fulfilment prep SKU', 'The item is identical and only the fulfilment or barcode workflow differs', 'Do not add duplicate child rows; map it to the existing child or suppress the duplicate request']
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4. Prohibited merges

Products made from different primary materials must not be merged unless the variation theme is explicitly material and the category permits it.

A multi-pack must not be submitted as a color or size variant when pack count affects value, shipping weight, or shopper comparison.

A product with an added infuser, filter, electronics, or other functionally meaningful accessory is a different product unless all children include the same accessory.

5. Image consistency

Child images must show the exact child product. Reusing a hero image for a different material, pack count, or included accessory creates a misleading variation.

Package images can be used as supporting assets but cannot override structured catalog attributes.

6. Evidence and submission notes

Catalog submissions should cite the source page, current catalog parent attributes, and any required fix before upload.

If a candidate could join under a different variation theme, mark `needs_fix` rather than reject outright, and specify the corrected theme or split-parent action.

Appendix A. Operational Review Checklist

Checkpoint	Reviewer action	Common failure mode
A1	Confirm the local source evidence supports the decision under Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference.	Treating sales notes, marketing copy, or screenshots as stronger evidence than the governing rule.
A2	Confirm the local source evidence supports the decision under Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference.	Treating sales notes, marketing copy, or screenshots as stronger evidence than the governing rule.
A3	Confirm the local source evidence supports the decision under Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference.	Treating sales notes, marketing copy, or screenshots as stronger evidence than the governing rule.
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A11	Confirm the local source evidence supports the decision under Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference.	Treating sales notes, marketing copy, or screenshots as stronger evidence than the governing rule.
A12	Confirm the local source evidence supports the decision under Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference.	Treating sales notes, marketing copy, or screenshots as stronger evidence than the governing rule.

Appendix B. Evidence Traceability Examples

Example 1: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Example 2: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Example 3: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

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Example 7: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Example 8: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Example 9: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Example 10: A compliant review cites the exact local file, page or section, and data field used for the conclusion. A non-compliant review merely says that the reviewer checked Marketplace Variation Family Policy - Local Reference without naming the operative rule, source record, or conflicting field.

Appendix C. Boundary Conditions and Tolerances

Boundary condition 1: When two local inputs conflict, the task-specific governing policy and the most source-specific evidence should control. Internal business requests are useful context but do not override policy, product scope, certificate scope, or audited numeric evidence.

Boundary condition 2: When two local inputs conflict, the task-specific governing policy and the most source-specific evidence should control. Internal business requests are useful context but do not override policy, product scope, certificate scope, or audited numeric evidence.

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